MAS MONTHLY

October 2026 | The official voice of MAS community. | Edition#1



INSIDE THIS ISSUE

• **Inside MAS**
The Voice Behind The Vision

• **Ask a Senior**

• **Counselor Insights**

• **Senior Year**
The beginning of the end

• **Clubs Insights**

• **MAS Life Highlight**

• **Al Maaref Monthly Reads**

• **From Our Community**

• **Upcoming Events**

The Voice Behind the Vision

As Al Maaref American School (MAS) welcomes its new principal, Mr. Wael, a new chapter begins for the school community. In this exclusive interview, we explore his journey in education, his vision for the future of MAS, and the opportunities and developments students can look forward to in the academic year ahead.

By Hadia Kamran & Nuray Aliyeva

1. **What inspired you to pursue a career in education?**

> *"I started teaching while studying in college and discovered how much I enjoyed it. After moving to Dubai, I continued growing through different positions until becoming a principal. But I was, am, and always will be a teacher."*

2. **Now that you've had some time to get to know MAS, what has stood out to you the most so far?**

> *"Two things: the students' positive attitudes towards learning and their teachers, and the staff's dedication to improvement and openness to change."*

Inside MAS: The Voice Behind The Vision (continued)

In this section, our principal shares more of his thoughts on the future of MAS, student life, and the values that make a school community thrive.

3. **What is one thing you would really like to achieve for our school as principal?**

"My goal is personalized learning, where every student receives education suited to their individual needs and abilities. AI can help teachers make this possible."

4. **How important do you think student voice is when it comes to making decisions about our school?**

"Students are the most important people in a school. Their opinions matter because they experience school life every day. I want to hear their feedback and involve them in making improvements."

6. **What do you think makes a school more than just a place for academics?**

"AI should be embraced rather than banned. Students must learn to use it ethically, responsibly, and effectively. I also want to help teachers incorporate AI into classrooms."

5. **With technology and AI developing so quickly, how do you think schools should prepare students for the future?**

"A school should be a place where students feel comfortable, heard, and supported. Education should also encourage personal growth and emotional well-being."

7. **What advice would you give to students who are about to graduate, as well as those who still have a few years of school ahead of them?**

"Cherish your school years and don't overwhelm yourselves with future decisions. Focus on short-term goals and take life one step at a time. You never know where your journey might lead."

8. **What do you enjoy doing when you're not at school?**

"I enjoy spending time with my family, drawing, swimming, and playing tennis. Family time is especially important to me."

9. **What is one fun fact about you that your students would probably be surprised to hear?**

"I'm a gamer! I enjoy playing online games with childhood friends whenever I have time. I also believe gaming can develop thinking skills and hand-eye coordination."

10. **When you look back at your first year at MAS, what would make you feel that it had been a successful year?**

"Seeing students happy, confident, and prepared for their next steps. I also hope to see greater consistency across the school and satisfaction among students, teachers, and parents."

> **"A SCHOOL SHOULD BE A PLACE WHERE STUDENTS FEEL COMFORTABLE, HEARD, AND SUPPORTED."**
> **-MR WAEL IBRAHIM**



ASK A SENIOR

By Sara Fikri, Hajar Khaild, and Ghaya Mohamed



Saif Alfayoumi

Planning Ahead

As seniors prepare for life after high school, we interviewed Saif about his activities, goals, and college plans.

What extracurricular activities are you involved in?
"I'm currently involved in MUN and TEDx. I'm Head of External Relations and Marketing in MUN and Head of Volunteers in TEDx. Beyond these leadership roles, I'm also actively taking part in volunteering opportunities and taking initiatives in many events."

Are you looking for scholarships?
"Absolutely. I'm mainly looking for an athletic scholarship since I play football at a high level. I'm planning to study somewhere in Europe and experience my college life there."

What are you doing to strengthen your application?
"I'm focusing on my studies, APs, board exams, extracurricular activities, and community service. I'm trying my best to get a 4 or higher on my AP exams because they're important for college."

Preparing for the Future

In this edition of Ask a Senior, Venus Mahmoudi shares how she is preparing for university and her plans after graduation.

What are you doing right now to prepare?
"I'm studying for my SAT to ensure I get a good score. I'm also studying for my AP exams and doing extracurricular activities to maintain my GPA and earn college credit."

What extracurricular activities are you taking?
"I'm in MUN and TEDx. I'm also taking AP Chemistry, AP Psychology, and AP Calculus."

How are you choosing your university?
"I'm looking into universities in Europe and thinking about going abroad. I'm trying to find universities that offer courses in English so I don't need to learn a new language."



Venus Mahmoudi

COUNSELOR INSIGHTS

By Mirna Raek & Jannat Mahir

Behind the Ballot: A Look at This Year's Student Council Elections

In this interview, Ms. Basma Ahmad shares how this year's Student Council elections were organized, the challenges involved in ensuring a fair process, and the importance of student voice. She also discusses future improvements and how elections encourage leadership and responsibility within the school community.



Ms. Basma Ahmad

How was this year's election process organized?

Preparations began with announcement posters and Microsoft Teams posts for secondary students, while elementary students were introduced to the elections through posters and homeroom sessions. Interested students collected and completed an application form that included personal information, an adult's recommendation, and the position they wished to run for.

What was the main goal of the elections?

The goal was to ensure that the Student Council has a greater impact on students' lives. The council is truly from students, for students, and every member is elected by their peers to represent their voices.

What were the biggest challenges?

Some positions initially had few nominees, so students had to be encouraged to step forward. In the elementary section, the large number of candidates was also a challenge. Campaign rules had to be monitored carefully to ensure fairness, and maintaining an honest voting process remained a top priority.

> *The Student Council is truly from students, for students.*
>
> — Ms. Basma Ahmed

Did candidates receive a fair opportunity?

Yes. Every candidate was given a fair and equal opportunity to campaign and present their ideas.

What could be improved next year?

One improvement would be holding all elections on the same day across elementary, middle, and secondary school. Another idea is to create a more realistic voting experience with a dedicated voting area, allowing students to line up and vote in a way that resembles real elections.

Was I satisfied with the results?

Absolutely. I was very happy with the results and praised the students for their hard work, ambition, and motivation to make a difference.

What are her expectations for this year's council?

I am optimistic that this year's Student Council will accomplish goals and initiatives that could not be fulfilled previously.

Senior Year
The Beginning of the End

Seniors begin their final year with new traditions, memorable moments, and exciting milestones that make their last year at MAS special.

By Leen Hisham

SENIOR JACKETS



Our first senior meeting with the school principal and vice principal marked the beginning of an exciting and memorable final year. During the meeting, the principal delivered a speech, shared expectations for the senior class, and explained the privileges and responsibilities that come with being a senior. Students were also given an overview of what to expect throughout the year, including the experiences, opportunities, and challenges ahead. The meeting encouraged seniors to lead by example, stay responsible, and make the most of their final year while creating lasting memories together.

FIRST SENIOR MEETING

On October 8, MAS seniors celebrated one of the biggest milestones of their final school year: receiving their senior jackets! The ceremony was filled with excitement, laughter, and unforgettable moments as students proudly received their jackets, marking a special step toward graduation. More than just a jacket, it represents the memories, friendships, achievements, and experiences that make senior year so meaningful. The celebration brought the seniors together, creating lasting memories and giving them another reason to cherish their final chapter at MAS. It was a fun and memorable occasion that made the journey toward graduation feel even more real!





The seniors' last first day was filled with excitement and emotions as they captured memories with friends. As they begin their final year, they cherish the little moments, knowing these memories will soon become part of their journey into adulthood.

Senior Year
The Beginning of the End

SENIOR BOARD



The Senior Board marks the beginning of a memorable final chapter for the graduating class. Featuring the seniors who have grown, learned, and shared countless experiences together, the board celebrates their individual journeys and collective achievements. More than just a display of photographs, it represents the friendships, memories, and milestones that have shaped their years. As graduation approaches, the Senior Board serves as a lasting reminder of their time together and the legacy they will leave behind as they prepare to begin new chapters beyond high school.

SENIOR BADGES



Each senior received their official Senior Badge, symbolizing achievement, identity, and unity. Wearing the badge throughout the year reminds them of their leadership responsibilities, the growth they have experienced, and the exciting journey toward graduation. It also encourages them to lead by example, support their classmates, and leave a positive legacy within the school community. As they begin their final chapter together, the badge becomes a meaningful reminder of the memories, friendships, and experiences they will carry beyond graduation.

Cybersecurity Awareness



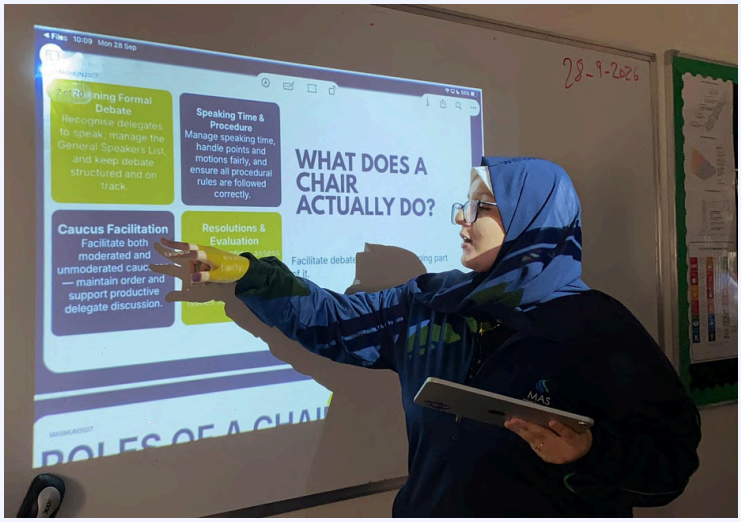
Al Maaref American School took the seniors to the Mujtama' Aman (Safe Community) awareness event at Al Khawaneej Majlis, organized in collaboration with the Dubai Cyber Security Center. The visit aimed to raise students' awareness of cybersecurity, information security, and the importance of using digital technologies and online platforms safely and responsibly.

CLUBS & STUDENT LIFE

Discover the clubs and activities bringing students together, from MUN and TedX to the Newsletter, Podcast and Yearbook Committee

MUN CLUB

The MUN Club at Al Maaref American School is conducting training sessions for both delegates and chairs to prepare students for upcoming conferences. Delegate training focuses on developing research, public speaking, debating, and resolution-writing skills, while chair training helps students learn how to lead committee sessions, manage debates, and maintain formal MUN procedures. Through these sessions, students gain practical experience, build confidence, and strengthen their understanding of diplomacy and international relations.



NEWSLETTER COMMITTEE

MAS
NEWSLETTER CLUB

The Newsletter Club plays an important role in keeping the school community informed about what is happening around campus. From school events and student achievements to activities, announcements, and special moments, the newsletter gives students a platform to share the stories that make up school life.

The club is made up of different roles, including writers, photographers, designers, editors, media members, and secretaries. Writers create articles and stories, photographers capture important moments, designers work on the visual presentation, and editors review the content before publication. The media team helps with coverage and promotion, while the secretary helps with organization and communication.

TEDx MAS Youth

The TEDx Club brings together ideas, creativity, public speaking, and event planning. The club gives students the opportunity to explore meaningful ideas and help create an event where speakers can share their experiences, knowledge, and perspectives with an audience.

There is also a lot of work behind the scenes. Students can contribute to different areas such as speaker support, content, design, promotion, organization, media, and event preparation. Members learn how to work under deadlines, communicate with a team, solve unexpected problems, and manage responsibilities during a major school event. The experience allows students to develop leadership, teamwork, communication, creativity, organization, and event-management skills.

TEDx
MAS Youth



LITERATURE PODCAST CLUB

The Lit Podcast Club provides students with a platform to explore literature, share ideas, and engage in meaningful conversations about books, authors, and stories. Through podcast discussions, book recommendations, and creative audio content, members explore different genres, exchange perspectives, and encourage a love of reading within the school community. The club also helps students develop their communication, critical thinking, research, and storytelling skills while building confidence in expressing their opinions. By bringing literature to life through engaging conversations, the club aims to make reading more accessible, enjoyable, and inspiring for students.

YEARBOOK COMMITTEE

The Yearbook Committee captures the school year's most memorable moments, celebrating students' experiences, school events, achievements, and special milestones. Through creative content, photography, and thoughtful organization, the committee brings together the highlights of the academic year in a meaningful and engaging way. From exciting school activities to everyday moments shared among friends, the yearbook preserves the memories that make each school year unique. By showcasing the school's spirit, diversity, and accomplishments, the committee creates a lasting keepsake that students can look back on and cherish long after the academic year ends.





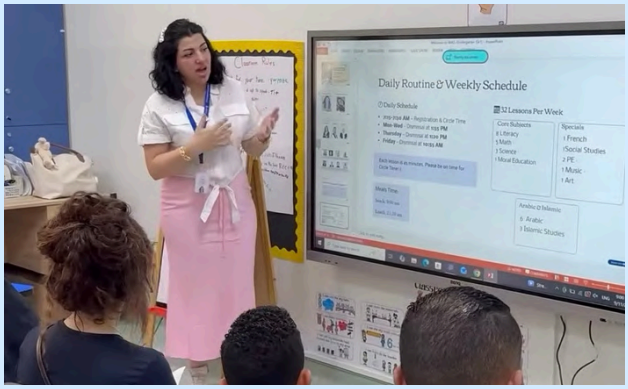
DEBATE CLUB

The Debate Club gives students a chance to discuss different topics, share their opinions, and challenge themselves to think from different perspectives. Members learn how to research topics, organize their ideas, build strong arguments, and respond to opposing viewpoints.
Through debates and discussions, students develop important skills such as public speaking, critical thinking, communication, confidence, and active listening. The club encourages students to express themselves respectfully while understanding that there can be different opinions on the same issue.

FIND YOUR PEOPLE. FIND YOUR PASSION.
Explore your interests, make new friends, and find your place. Join a club and be part of what makes MAS special!

THIS MONTH AT MAS

From Literacy Day to Democracy day, students took part in activities and events that filled the month with learning and school spirit



MEET & GREET

MAS welcomed parents to the school for a Meet & Greet, providing an opportunity for parents to meet their children's teachers and learn more about the school year ahead. The event encouraged open communication between families and teachers, allowing parents to discuss their children's learning, progress, and classroom experience.

PEACE DAY

Students at MAS celebrated the International Day of Peace by wearing white to represent peace, unity, and harmony. An assembly for all grades was held as part of the celebration, giving students the opportunity to learn more about the significance of peace and the importance of respect, understanding, and kindness within the school community. The assembly highlighted how peace extends beyond the absence of conflict and begins with the way people treat one another in their daily lives. Students were encouraged to reflect on how their words, actions, and choices can help create a more peaceful and inclusive environment. The occasion also emphasized the importance of accepting differences, resolving disagreements respectfully, and showing empathy toward others. The celebration served as an opportunity for students to consider their role in building a school environment where everyone feels safe, respected, valued, and included, reinforcing the message that peace begins with each of us.



DOT DAY

MAS celebrated International Dot Day with our KG–Grade 5 students, encouraging creativity, imagination, and self-expression. Students joined in the celebration by wearing colorful outfits and clothing covered in dots, bringing the theme to life throughout the school. The hallways were filled with bright colors and cheerful designs, creating a fun and festive atmosphere.

The day featured playful and interactive experiences planned for younger students, giving them the opportunity to learn, create, and enjoy the celebration alongside their teachers. Inspired by the idea that even a small dot can spark something amazing, students were encouraged to explore their creativity, try new things, and express their unique ideas. The celebration reminded everyone that great things can begin with one small step!



HEART DAY

On October 2, MAS brought a touch of red to the school as students marked Heart Day by wearing red and taking part in a school-wide celebration. The day created an opportunity for students to focus on the importance of caring for themselves and others while spreading a positive message throughout the school.
Adding to the celebration, senior students prepared interactive experiences for younger grades and shared small gifts with their peers. These thoughtful efforts made the day more engaging and helped spread the spirit of Heart Day across the school.









INTERNATIONAL DAY OF SIGN LANGUAGE

MAS marked the International Day of Sign Languages by encouraging students to explore the importance of communication. The day provided an opportunity for students to learn more about sign language and how it allows people to connect, express themselves, and communicate with others.



Students took part in an engaging presentation and interactive experiences that introduced them to basic signs and helped them understand the role of sign language in creating a more inclusive community.

DEMOCRACY DAY





On September 15, MAS celebrated Democracy Day, highlighting the importance of having a voice, respecting different perspectives, and participating in the community. Students explored democratic values, including fairness, equality, and collective responsibility.

The event introduced students to MASMUN through interactive booths, where they met the team, explored its departments, learned how they contribute to a successful conference, and discovered opportunities in diplomacy, leadership, and debate.

Across the school, students also took part in teacher-led activities about democracy, encouraging them to share ideas, respect different opinions, and value cooperation and active participation.

FIRE DRILL & EVACUATION

As part of MAS's commitment to maintaining a safe school environment, students and staff participated in two practical emergency drills: a fire drill and an evacuation drill. These exercises helped everyone understand the correct emergency procedures and how to respond safely and responsibly.

During the drills, participants followed instructions, moved safely to designated areas, and practiced responding calmly and efficiently. The exercises emphasized listening carefully, staying composed, and cooperating during unexpected situations, reinforcing the importance of preparedness, awareness, and teamwork in ensuring the safety and well-being of the entire school community.

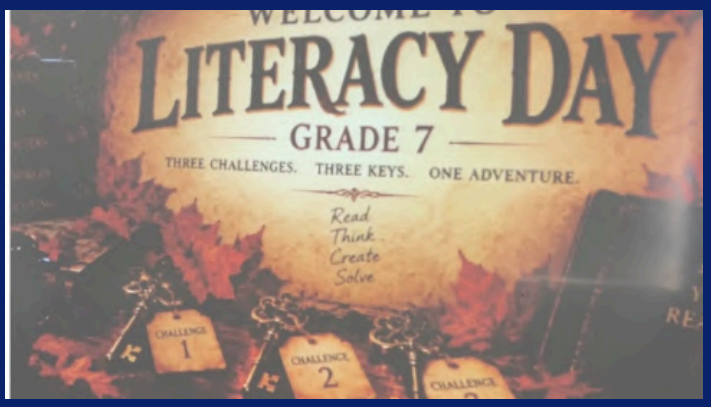


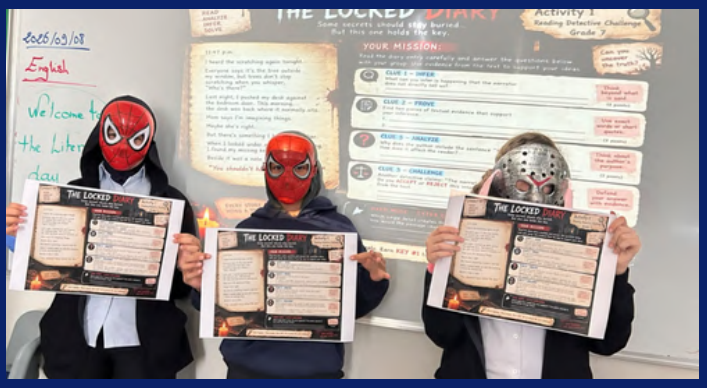
LITERACY DAY

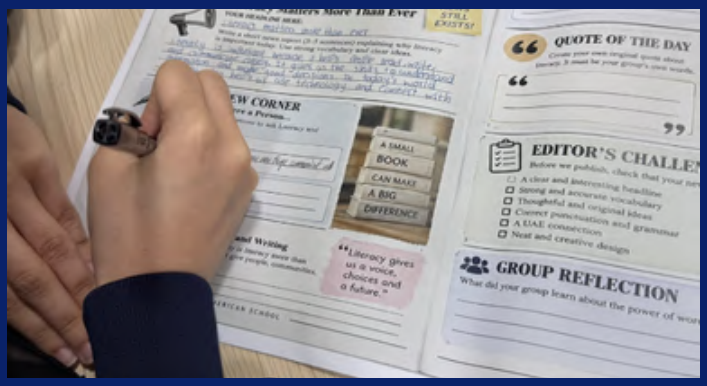
On September 8, MAS celebrated Literacy Day by highlighting the importance of reading, writing, and communication through creative and interactive English activities.

Grade 12 students participated in a unique escape-room mystery about an author mysteriously killed in his office. Suspecting one of his four writing components, he left clues and evidence hidden in books and around the room. Students examined the clues, connected the evidence, and worked to solve the mystery.

Meanwhile, other classes celebrated through classroom activities that explored the importance of language in fun and meaningful ways.









SUDOKU DAY

MAS celebrated Sudoku Day by challenging students with one of the world's most popular logic puzzles. Through Sudoku challenges of varying difficulty, students tested their problem-solving, logical reasoning, and critical-thinking skills while practicing strategic thinking, pattern recognition, and patience. The activity offered a fun way to explore mathematics beyond the classroom, highlighting how simple puzzles can strengthen essential skills and make learning interactive and enjoyable.

TEACHER'S DAY

On October 6, MAS celebrated World Teachers' Day, recognizing the dedication, guidance, and hard work of teachers who make a lasting difference in students' lives. Beyond the classroom, teachers encourage curiosity, build confidence, and inspire students to reach their full potential. The occasion served as a reminder to appreciate their patience, commitment, and the countless ways they support the school community. Their impact extends far beyond lessons, shaping not only what students learn, but also who they become.



MENTAL HEALTH DAY

On October 9, MAS recognized World Mental Health Day, encouraging students to reflect on the importance of mental well-being and emotional health. Students wore green to show their support for mental health awareness and help promote a culture of understanding, kindness, and acceptance within the school community. The occasion served as a reminder that mental health is just as important as physical health and deserves care, attention, and open conversations.





The day also highlighted the importance of creating a supportive environment where everyone feels comfortable expressing their feelings and seeking help when needed. Through small acts of kindness, listening without judgment, and checking in on one another, students can make a meaningful difference in someone's day. World Mental Health Day encouraged the MAS community to break down stigma, support those facing challenges, and remember that no one has to face difficult moments alone.

AL MAAREF | MONTHLY READS

Read. Discover. Shine.

Three books. Three adventures. A whole world waiting between the pages.

By: Hadia Kamran

ELEMENTARY | The Wild Robot On The Island
By Peter Brown

What happens when a robot wakes up alone on a wild island? Meet Roz, who must learn to survive, befriend the island's animals and discover where she truly belongs. A heartwarming adventure about kindness, nature and friendship.



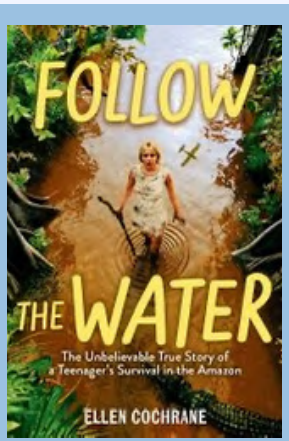
MIDDLE SCHOOL | The Explorer
By Katherine Rundell

A plane crash leaves four children stranded in the Amazon rainforest, far from help. As they face the challenges of the jungle, they must rely on courage, teamwork and their wits to find a way home. An unforgettable adventure of survival and discovery.



HIGH SCHOOL | Follow the Water
By Ellen Cochrane

Could you survive eleven days alone in the Amazon rainforest? In this extraordinary true story, seventeen-year-old Juliane Koepcke survives a plane crash and must navigate the dangerous jungle alone. A gripping story of resilience, resourcefulness and the incredible power of the human spirit.



YOUR NEXT ADVENTURE STARTS WITH A PAGE.

FROM OUR COMMUNITY

Hear thoughtful messages from our wellness team, teacher, and parents as they share encouragement, and support with the MAS community!

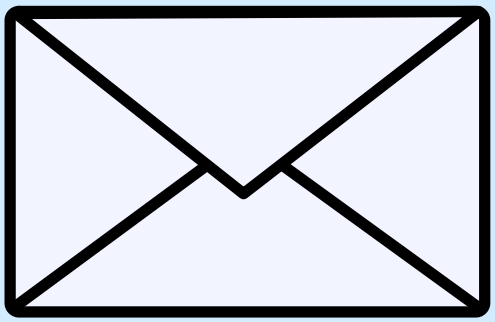
TEACHER'S MESSAGE

It has been a great start to the new school year. The first few weeks have been a time for students and teachers to settle back into our routines, meet new people, and get ready for another year of learning and growth.

Over the past five to six weeks, it has been wonderful to see students getting involved in their classes, activities, and different aspects of school life. Starting a new school year always comes with new challenges, but it also brings new opportunities to learn, improve, and create positive memories.



Mr. Muhammad Haider



PARENT'S MESSAGE

My name is Hanan, and I would like to talk about the school. As a parent, I am very pleased with Al Maaref American School. The teachers are caring, professional, and supportive, and the students are respectful and friendly. The school provides a positive and welcoming environment where students can learn, grow, and succeed. Overall, I am very happy with the school and the education it provides.

WELLNESS MESSAGE

This Month's Focus: Managing Stress

A new school year brings fresh opportunities, new responsibilities, and sometimes a little more pressure than expected. Between assignments, exams, extracurricular activities, and personal commitments, it can be easy to feel overwhelmed. Remember that adjusting takes time, and you don't have to have everything figured out from day one.

YOUR MONTHLY REMINDER: PAUSE, RESET, AND RECHARGE.

When everything starts to feel like too much, give yourself permission to take a short break. Step away from your work for ten minutes, drink some water, stretch, or get some fresh air. A little breathing room can help you return to your tasks feeling calmer and more focused. Managing stress isn't about doing everything perfectly. It's about finding healthy ways to handle challenges without forgetting to look after yourself.

A MOMENT TO REFLECT

Have I given myself enough time to rest, recharge, and enjoy the little things today?

Remember, asking for support is a strength, not a weakness. Whether you talk to a friend, teacher, school counselor, or family member, you don't have to navigate stressful moments alone. Take things one step at a time, celebrate your progress, and give yourself the same patience you would offer someone else. Your well-being matters just as much as your achievements.

UPCOMING *Events*



Tuesday

Najah University Fair

Students will explore universities, programs, and admission requirements.

Oct **27** 2026



Thursday

Breast Cancer Awareness

Students will learn about breast cancer awareness, early detection, and supporting those affected.

Oct **29** 2026



Friday

Parents Meeting

Parents will meet teachers to discuss academic progress and support their children's learning.

Oct **30** 2026



Tuesday

UAE Flag Day

Students will celebrate UAE Flag Day, honoring the national flag and the UAE's heritage.

Nov **3** 2026



Wednesday

TEDx Mas Youth

A platform for students to share ideas, inspire others, and explore new perspectives.

Nov **4** 2026



Friday

World Diabetes Day

Raising awareness about diabetes, early detection, management, and healthy lifestyle choices.

Nov **13** 2026

MAS MONTHLY

October 2026 | | *The official voice of MAS community.* | Edition 01

THANK YOU FOR READING

This edition was made possible by the dedication, creativity, and collaboration of our student team.

We hope you enjoyed this month's issue, and we look forward to bringing you more stories from our MAS community next month.

Stay Connected

@MAS.MONTHLY

MASMONTHLY@MAS.AE

ALMAAREF.AE

October Newsletter Team

WRITERS / EDITORS / DESIGNERS / PHOTOGRAPHERS

Hadia Kamran

Nuray Aliyeva

Jannat Mahir

Mirna Raek

Haya Khalid

Alamira Bayan Anas

Hajar Khalid

Mira Khalid

Sara Fikri

Ghaya Mohamed

Leen Hisham

Mariam Moatasem

Sarah Ahamd

Rawan Fikri

Raneem Naser

Haya Naser

Latifa Saeed

